

Zhuoyu (Rachel) Qiu

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on applied microeconomics, particularly labor economics and the economics of education. I study human capital accumulation in educational settings, child and family well-being, and the effects of public policies using large-scale administrative data and causal inference methods.

EDUCATION

- **University of California, Riverside** Riverside, CA, USA
Ph.D. in Economics Sep. 2021 – Jun. 2027 (expected)
- **Jinan University** Guangzhou, China
M.S. in Economics, with Honors Sep. 2019 – Jun. 2021
- **Zhongnan University of Economics and Law** Wuhan, China
B.S. in Economics, with Honors Sep. 2014 – Jun. 2019

JOB MARKET PAPER

- **Gender Peer Effects and Women's Academic Performance in Mathematics: Evidence from a U.S. University**
Abstract: Understanding how educational environments shape women's mathematics achievement and persistence can help explain their continued underrepresentation in mathematics-intensive fields despite rising educational attainment. This paper examines the role of classroom gender composition using administrative records for freshmen entering a selective U.S. public university between 2016 and 2023. I exploit variation in female peer share across introductory mathematics classes within the same course-term-instructor group, allowing fixed effects to differ by student gender. A 10-percentage-point increase in female peer share raises women's probability of completing introductory mathematics by approximately 3.0 percentage points and their share of first-quarter courses completed by 2.4 percentage points. Greater female peer exposure also improves women's attainment of grades of C- or better. Men benefit in broader first-quarter outcomes, with limited evidence of differences in effects across genders. The findings remain robust after accounting for gender composition in other courses and excluding pandemic-entry cohorts. Benefits for women are concentrated among students who declared a STEM major at entry, while comparable positive effects do not emerge in other entry-term subjects. Longer-term estimates provide suggestive evidence of increased STEM degree attainment among students entering with a STEM major.

PUBLICATION

- [1] Qiu, Z. (2026). **Punching Out, Not Down: The Impact of Paid Sick Leave on Child Maltreatment.** *Labour Economics*, 102958. doi:10.1016/j.labeco.2026.102958.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Effects of Faculty Gender Attitudes on College Students' Short- and Long-Term Outcomes**
With Radhika Bansal (University of California, Riverside), Ozkan Eren (University of California, Riverside), Krzysztof Karbownik (Emory University), Ruinan Zhao (State of California Department of Industrial Relations)
 - We link university administrative records (2013–2024) to faculty responses on the Gender-Science Implicit Association Test to examine student achievement, major choice, STEM persistence, graduation, and earnings outcomes.
 - Preliminary findings indicate that female students taught by instructors with stronger implicit gender bias are more likely to leave their declared majors and less likely to graduate on time.
- **The Impact of Marriage Tax Bonus and Penalty on Marital Decisions in the U.S.**
With Zhe Yang (Liaoning University)
 - We examine marriage formation and dissolution using the Survey of Income and Program Participation. We measure marriage tax bonuses and penalties relative to after-tax income and construct an instrument using variation in tax incentives across states and demographic groups.
 - Our results show that, for cohabitating couples, 1% increase in MB-to-income ratio leads to 0.12% increase in the likelihood of getting married. As for married couples, the elasticity of MB-to-income ratio to the likelihood of marital dissolution is -0.14

TECHNICAL AND POLICY REPORTS

- [1] Bates, M., Bruene, S., Calderon, E. E., De La Torre, E., Freire, P., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Jackson, K., Kapoor, M., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Reese, E., Rettberg, G., and Tamayose, B. C. (2023). **The State of Work in the Inland Empire Part II: Pandemic, Polarization, Inflation, and Investment.** *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside.*
- [2] Bainiwal, T. S., Bates, M., Brookes, M., Bruene, S., Calderon, E., Carranza, N., De La Torre, E., Freire, P., Gudis, C., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Jackson, K., Kapoor, M., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Reese, E., Rettberg, G., Tamayose, B., and Tan, A. (2024). **The State of Work: Transportation, Distribution, and Logistics in the Inland Empire.** *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside.*
- [3] Bates, M., Brookes, M., Bruene, S., Burnett, J., Calderon, E., Carbajal, A., De La Torre, E., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Kapoor, M., Mukenge, K., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Rana, S., Reese, E., Rettberg, G., Salam, I., and Tamayose, B. (2024). **Thrive Inland SoCal: Labor Market Analysis.** *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside.*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **University of California, Riverside** Riverside, CA, USA
 - Instructor of Record Aug. 2025
 - Urban Economics (*Summer 2025*)
 - Teaching Assistant Oct. 2022 – Now
 - Introductory Econometrics (*Fall 2022; Winter 2023; Winter & Fall 2024; Winter, Spring, & Fall 2025; Winter 2026*)
 - Statistics for Economics (*Fall 2023*)
 - Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (*Spring 2024; Spring 2026*)
 - Software Instructor, Jul. – Aug. 2023
 - Stata Boot Camp, Master of Public Policy Program
 - Pedagogical Training Jul. 2026
 - Summer Curriculum Design Institute

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- **Department of Economics, University of California, Riverside** Riverside, CA, USA
 - Graduate Student Researcher Jul. – Sep. 2026
- **Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside** Riverside, CA, USA
 - Graduate Student Researcher Apr. – Jun. 2023
- **Peking University HSBC Business School** Remote
 - Research Assistant Dec. 2020 – Jun. 2021
- **Guangzhou Academy of Social Sciences** Guangdong, China
 - Research Assistant Aug. – Dec. 2020

PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

- Economic Seminar Series, California State University Long Beach (*Scheduled*) Long Beach, CA, USA, 2026
- Southern Economic Association (SEA) 96th Annual Meeting (*Department nominated, Scheduled*) Houston, TX, USA, 2026
- International Symposium on Contemporary Labor Economics, Xiamen University Xiamen, China, 2025
- Southern Economic Association (SEA) 95th Annual Meeting Tampa, FL, USA, 2025
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Conference Seattle, WA, USA, 2025
- 18th All-California Labor Economics Conference, Stanford University Stanford, CA, USA, 2025
- China Economics Society (CES) China Annual Conference, Sun Yat-sen University Guangzhou, China, 2025
- SEMi-Talk Academic Workshop, Tsinghua University Beijing, China, 2024
- 15th All-California Labor Economics Conference, University of California, Riverside Riverside, CA, USA, 2022

REFeree SERVICE

- Journal of Labor Research

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Dean's Distinguished Fellowship, University of California, Riverside *2021 – Present*
- Outstanding Graduate Award, Jinan University *2019 – 2021*

SKILLS

- **Software:** Stata, Python, MATLAB, R, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Qualtrics
- **Additional Skills:** Policy report writing, survey design, data visualization

REFERENCES

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